

[Edit](#)

Create a Class from a Prompt Using GitHub Copilot

Challenge Overview

Understand the scenario

You are a Developer at Hexelo using GitHub Copilot in VS Code to generate a Python class from a natural-language prompt.

In this Challenge Lab, you will create a Class from a prompt by using GitHub Copilot. First, you will set up your environment and create sample data. Next, you will use GitHub Copilot to generate a working class. Finally, you will enhance the class with validation and new features.

 You must complete the **Set Up Git and Connect to GitHub** setup lab before starting any challenge in this series. The set-up lab should only be completed once.

Navigating the Challenge Lab

Unable to process content from <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/LODSContent/Challenge-V3-Framework/main/Templates/Environments/None.md>

 ► Quick tips for navigating the Challenge Lab instructions.

[New to Challenge Labs? Click here to learn more.](#)

Prepare the workspace

Hints Enabled

No Yes

 You must complete the **Set Up Git and Connect to GitHub** setup lab before starting any challenge in this series. The set-up lab should only be completed once.

- Sign in to the virtual machine as **LabUser** by using  **Passw0rd!** as the password.
- Enter your GitHub Username, Email Address, and Password into the following associated textboxes:

GitHub Username

GitHub Email Address

GitHub Password

- Open **Microsoft Edge**, go to  <https://github.com>, and then sign in as  **<GithubUN>** by using  **<GithubPW>** as the password.

 Expand this hint for guidance on signing in to a GitHub account.

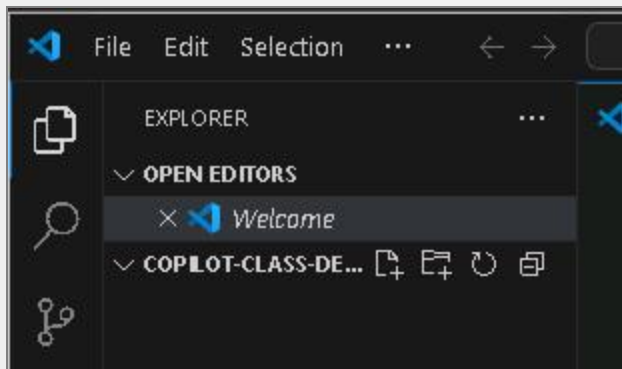
- On the Windows taskbar, in Search, enter **Edge**, and then select **Microsoft Edge** to open a new browser.
- In the Address bar, enter  <https://github.com>, and then press **Enter**.
- On the GitHub home page, in the upper right-hand corner, select **Sign in**.
- On the *Sign in to GitHub* page, in Username or email address, sign in as  [`<GithubUN>`](#) using  [`<GithubPW>`](#) as the password.
- If presented with the *Save password* dialog, select **Never**.
- On the *Device verification* page, enter the **Device Verification Code** sent to the email address used to register the account.

 Leave the **GitHub** browser window open.

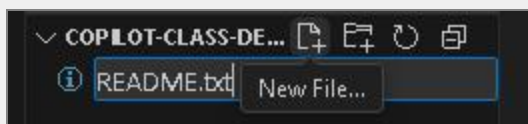
- In  [Visual Studio Code](#), create a project folder named  [`copilot-class-demo`](#) in  [`D:\LabFiles`](#), and then create a blank  [`README.txt`](#) file to verify folder access.

💡 Expand this hint for guidance on creating a project folder and a blank README.txt file. ^

- On the Windows taskbar, in Search, enter **T** Visual Studio Code, and select it to open **VS Code**.
- Close the two *Welcome* tabs.
- In **VS Code**, select **File**, and then select **Open Folder...**
- Navigate to **T** D:\LabFiles, select *New folder*, enter **T** copilot-class-demo to create a folder, double-click on the new folder to open it, and then select **Select Folder**.
- On the *Do you trust the authors of the files in this folder?* dialog, select **Yes, I trust the authors**.
- Confirm the folder appears in the Explorer pane.



- In **VS Code**, select the **New File** icon.



- Name the file **T** README.txt.

💡 Want to learn more? Review the documentation on [opening folders in VS Code](#).

- Add a sample CSV file to the **copilot-class-demo** folder named **T** students.csv, and then add the following data:

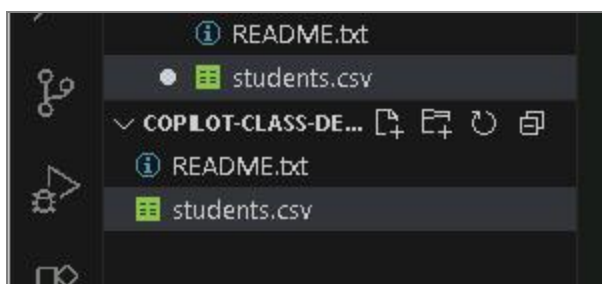
```
name,age,grade
Anna,15,89
Ben,14,92
Cara,15,85
```

💡 Expand this hint for guidance on adding a sample data file.

- In the Explorer, in the **copilot-class-demo** folder, select **New File**, and then name it **students.csv**.
- Copy the following code from above and paste it into the **students.csv** file.
- **Save** the file.

💡 Want to learn more? Review the documentation on [working with files in VS Code](#).

- Confirm that **students.csv** appears in the **copilot-class-demo** folder list.



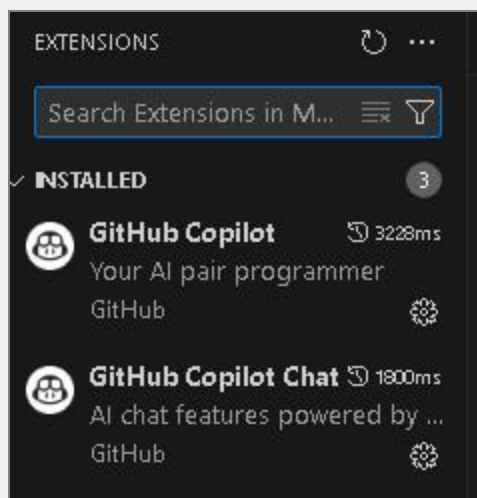
- Verify that GitHub Copilot is installed in **VS Code**.

💡 Expand this hint for guidance on verifying GitHub Copilot setup.

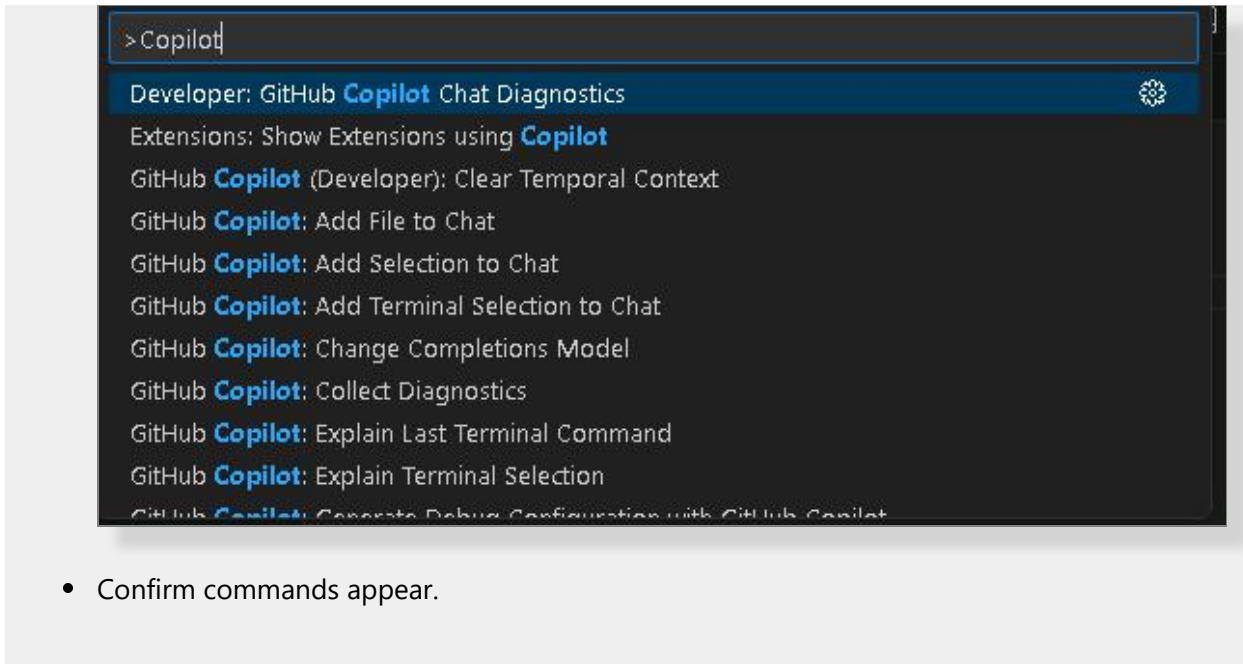
- Select the **Extensions** icon in **VS Code**.



- Search for, and if necessary, install:
 - **T** GitHub Copilot
 - **T** GitHub Copilot Chat



- Select **Ctrl+Shift+P**, and then enter **T** Copilot.



- Confirm commands appear.

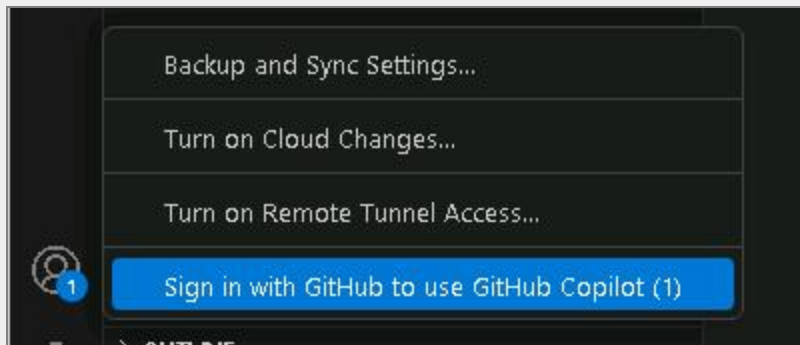


Want to learn more? Review the documentation on [setting up GitHub Copilot in VS Code](#).

- Sign in with GitHub to use GitHub Copilot as <GithubUN> by using <GithubPW> as the password.

💡 Expand this hint for guidance on signing in to a GitHub account in VS Code. ^

- In **VS Code**, in the lower left-hand corner, select the Accounts icon, select **Sign in**, and then select **Sign in with GitHub to use GitHub Copilot**.



- On the *Authorize Visual Studio Code* page, select **Continue**, and then select **Open**.

Note: The following steps may not be needed if you have already signed in.

- On the GitHub home page, in the upper right-hand corner, select **Sign in**.
- On the *Sign in to GitHub* page, in Username or email address, sign in as T <GithubUN> using T <GithubPW> as the password.
- If presented with the *Save password* dialog, select **Never**.
- On the *Device verification* page, enter the **Device Verification Code** sent to the email address used to register the account.

- Open a terminal and confirm Python is installed.

💡 Expand this hint for guidance on confirming Python installation. ^

- Select the Terminal icon on the taskbar, and then select **New Terminal**.
- Run the following command:

```
bash
```

📄 `python --version`

- Ensure a valid Python version appears.

```
PS C:\Users\LabUser> python --version
Python 3.12.10
PS C:\Users\LabUser> |
```

💡 Want to learn more? Review the documentation on [running Python in VS Code](#).

Check your work

Verify

Generate and test code with Copilot

Hints Enabled

No Yes

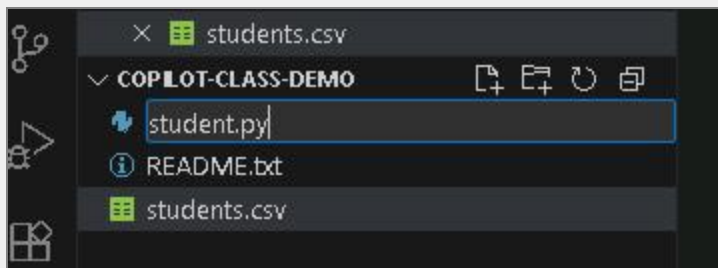
- Create a new file named `T student.py` to seed a descriptive comment block for Copilot by using the following, and then save the file in the **copilot-class-demo** folder:

python

```
# Create a class Student:
# - Attributes: name:str, age:int, grade:float
# - Methods:
#     __init__(name, age, grade)
#     __str__ -> "Name (Age): Grade"
#     is_passing() -> bool # grade >= 70
#     @classmethod load_from_csv(path:str) -> List[Student]
# - Use csv module
# - Handle missing/bad rows safely
# - Include Enter the following hints and docstrings
```

💡 Expand this hint for guidance on seeding a descriptive comment block. ^

- In the Explorer, select **New File**, and then name it `T student.py`.



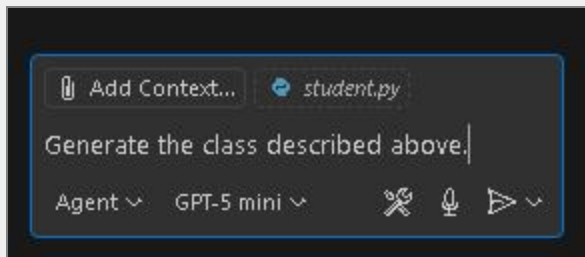
- Copy the comment block provided above and paste it into the new file.
- Move the cursor below the comment.
- **Save** the file.

💡 Want to learn more? Review the documentation on [writing effective Copilot prompts](#).

- Generate the **Student** class using the Copilot Chat with the prompt T Generate the class described above..

💡 Expand this hint for guidance on generating the class using Copilot Inline Chat. ^

- Select **Ctrl+Shift+I** to open the Copilot Chat window, and then enter the following: T
Generate the class described above..



- Select **Send**, and then wait for Copilot's suggestion.
- Ensure it includes the following:
 - `__init__`
 - `__str__`
 - `is_passing`
 - `load_from_csv`

```
def __init__(self, name: str, age: int, grade: int):
    """Initialize a Student.

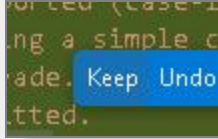
    Args:
        name: student's name
        age: student's age
        grade: student's numeric grade
    """
    self.name = name
    self.age = age
    self.grade = grade

def __str__(self) -> str:
    """Return a readable string: 'Name (Age): Grade'
    return f"{self.name} ({self.age}): {self.grade}"

def is_passing(self) -> bool:
    """Return True when the student's grade is 70 or above
    return self.grade >= 70

    @classmethod
    def load_from_csv(cls, path: str) -> List['Student']:
        """Load students from a CSV file.
```

- Select **Keep** to accept the suggestion.



 Want to learn more? Review the documentation on [using Inline Chat in VS Code](#).

 If missing pieces, run Copilot Chat again with the following prompt:

 Add required imports and robust error handling.

- Add the following code to the **student.py** file, and test the code execution by running the T `python student.py` command in the Terminal.

python



```
if __name__ == "__main__":  
    group = Student.load_from_csv("students.csv")  
    for s in group:  
        print(s, "Passing:", s.is_passing())
```

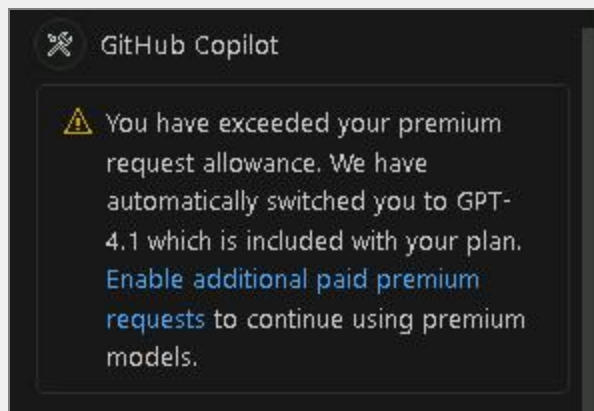
💡 Expand this hint for guidance on testing code.

- Copy the code block from above, and append it to the bottom of the **student.py** file.
- In the Terminal, navigate to the **copilot-class-demo** folder, and then run the following command:

```
bash
```

```
python student.py
```

NOTE: If you receive the following alert, you may ignore it and continue:



- Expected output:

```
PS D:\LabFiles\copilot-class-demo> python --version
Python 3.12.10
PS D:\LabFiles\copilot-class-demo> python student.py
Anna (15): 89.0 Passing: True
Ben (14): 92.0 Passing: True
Cara (15): 85.0 Passing: True
PS D:\LabFiles\copilot-class-demo> |
```

💡 Want to learn more? Review the documentation on [running and debugging Python code in VS Code](#).

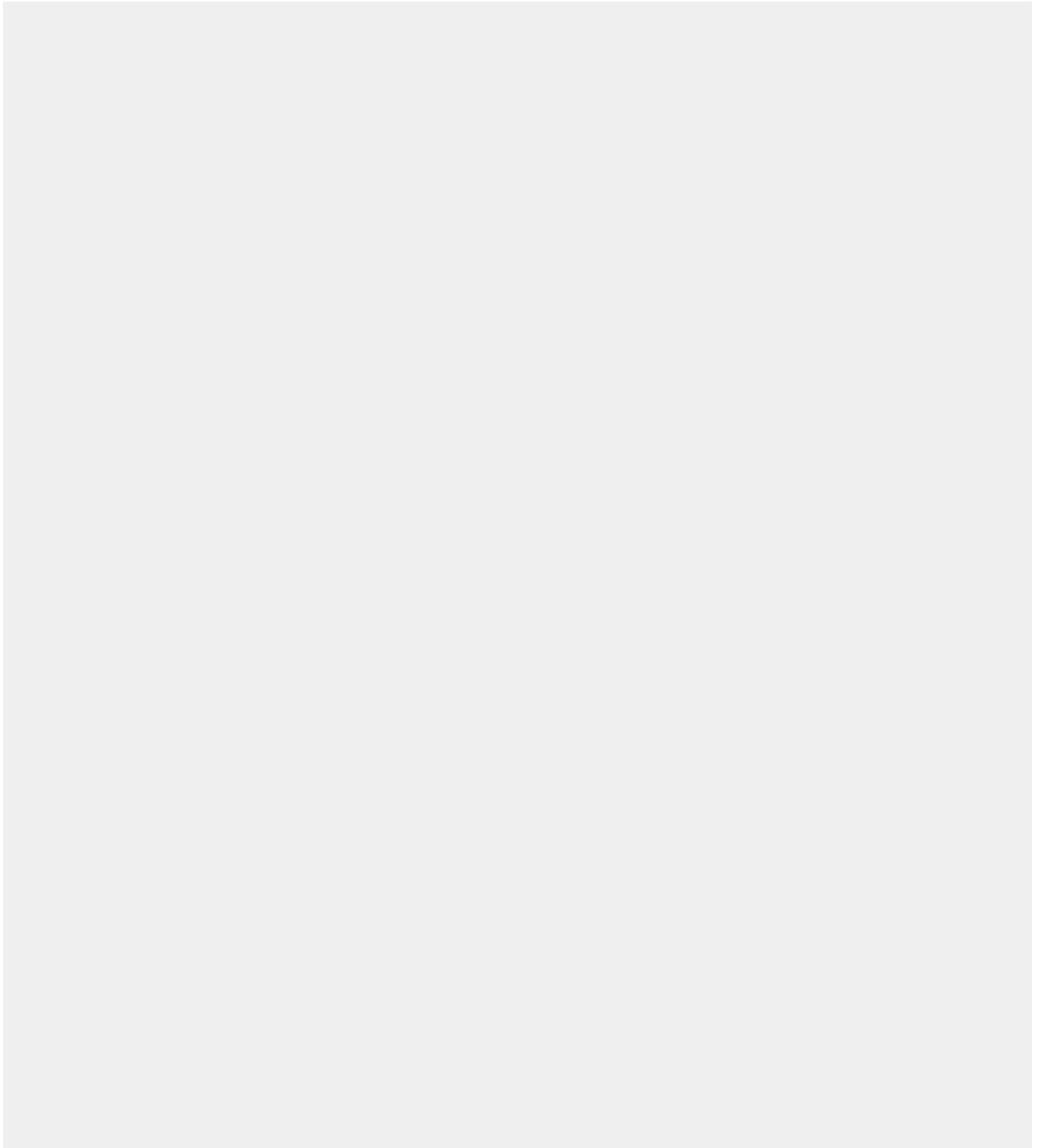
❓ Test modifications by adjusting comments and regenerating code.

💡 Want to learn more? Review the documentation on [GitHub Copilot](#).

Check your work



Verify



Enhance code and extend a class with Copilot

Hints Enabled

No Yes

- Add input validation and docstrings by using the prompt T Add input validation and detailed docstrings for all methods. using Copilot Inline Chat.

💡 Expand this hint for guidance on adding input validation and docstrings.

- Select inside the **Student class** definition.
- Open Copilot Inline Chat (**Ctrl+I**), and then enter **T** Add input validation and detailed docstrings for all methods..

```
5
6 class Student:
7     """Representation of a student.
8
9     Attributes:
10         name (str): student's name
11         age (int): student's age
12         grade (float): numeric grade
13         ....
```

Add input validation and detailed docstrings for all methods.

GPT-4.1 @ 🔊 ➤

- Select **Send**, and then accept the update and verify changes.

13

📌 Add input validation and detailed docstrings for all methods.

Ask Copilot GPT-4.1 @ 🔊 ▶

Accept Close ↺ ▼

```

14     def __setattr__(self, name, value):
15         """Set attribute with validation.
16
17         Args:
18             name (str): Attribute name.
19             value: Attribute value.
20
21         Raises:
22             ValueError: If validation fails.
23         """
24         if name == "name":
25             if not isinstance(value, str) or not va
26                 raise ValueError("Name must be a no
27         elif name == "age":
28             if not isinstance(value, int) or value
29                 raise ValueError("Age must be a non
30         elif name == "grade":
31             if not isinstance(value, (int, float))
32                 raise ValueError("Grade must be a n
33         super().__setattr__(name, value)
34     def __init__(self, name: str, age: int, grade:

```

💡 Want to learn more? Review the documentation on [Docstring Conventions in Python](#).

❓ If you end up with two copies of methods, expand this drop-down for help. ^

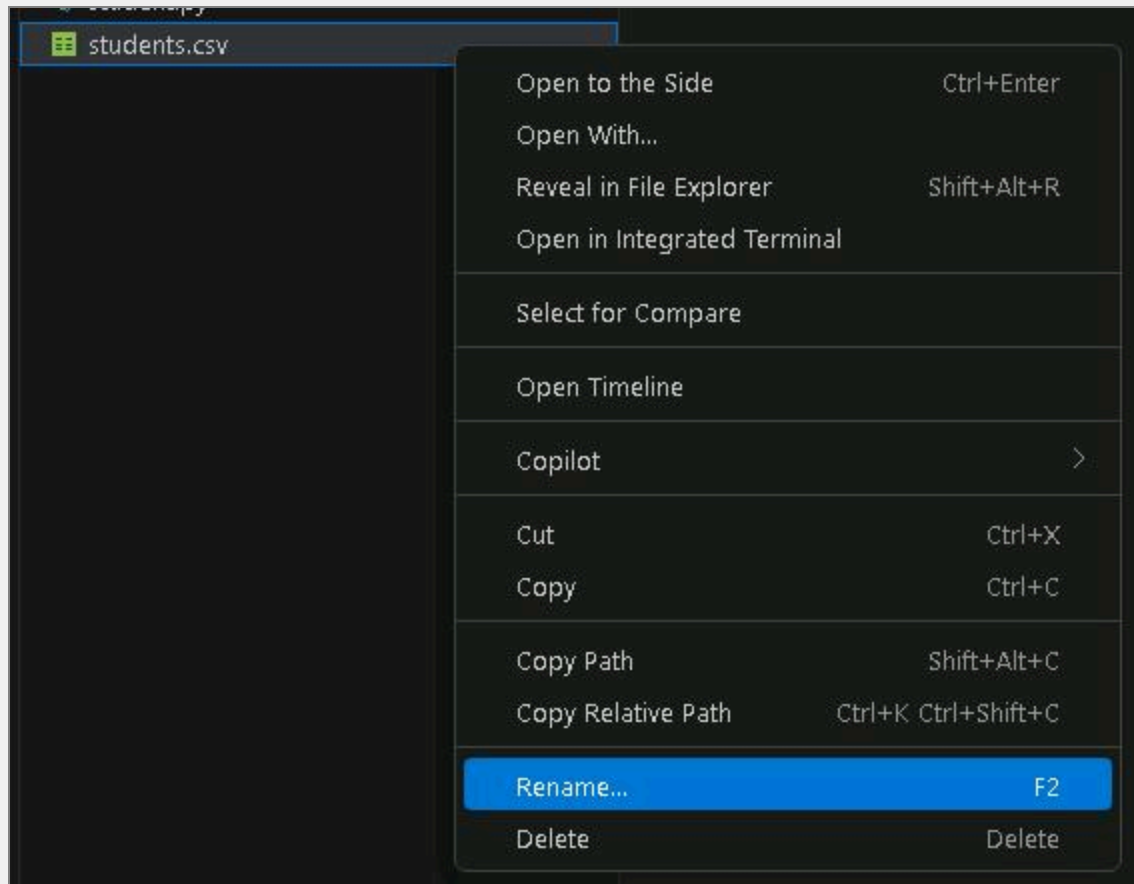
- Enter this prompt into the Copilot Chat window.

📄 Remove the older versions of these methods `__init__`, `__str__`, `is_passing`, and `load_from_csv`. Keep the ones that are the most recently generated.

- Rename **students.csv** to **Tstudents_missing.csv**, test the **student.py** script's error handling for missing files, and then restore the original name.

💡 Expand this hint for guidance on testing error handling for missing files.

- Rename **students.csv** to **T students_missing.csv**.



- In the Terminal, run the following command:

```
bash
```

 `python student.py`

- Confirm that the script handles missing files gracefully (no crash).

```
PS D:\LabFiles\copilot-class-demo> python student.py
D:\LabFiles\copilot-class-demo\student.py:86: UserWarning: File not found: students.csv
  warnings.warn(f"File not found: {path}")
PS D:\LabFiles\copilot-class-demo> |
```

- Rename back to **T students.csv**.
- Run the following command:

```
bash
```

 `python student.py`

- Confirm that the script runs as expected.

```
PS D:\LabFiles\copilot-class-demo> python student.py
Anna (15): 89.0 Passing: True
Ben (14): 92.0 Passing: True
Cara (15): 85.0 Passing: True
PS D:\LabFiles\copilot-class-demo> |
```



Want to learn more? Review the documentation on [handling exceptions in Python](#).

- Add a new `letter_grade()` method by first entering a comment at the end of the class (before the test method), and then using a prompt with Copilot Inline Chat. Use the values in the following table for the comment and the prompt.

Property	Value
Comment	<code># Add a method letter_grade() returning A/B/C/D/F using 90/80/70/60 cutoffs.</code>
Prompt	<code>Add a new letter_grade() method. Generate this new method.</code>

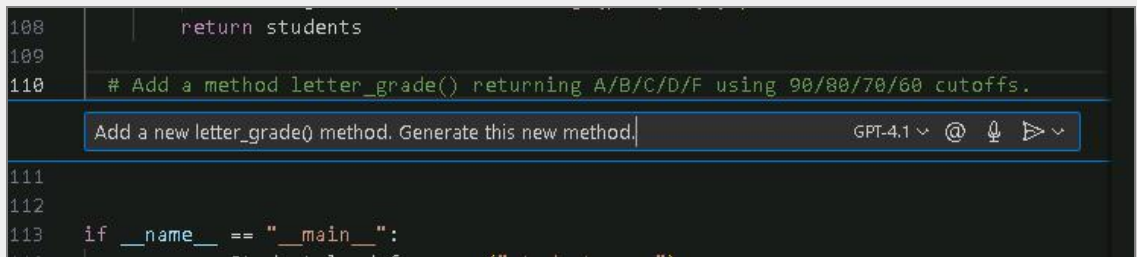
 Expand this hint for guidance on adding a new method.

- In **student.py**, add the following comment at the end of the class, before the test method:

python

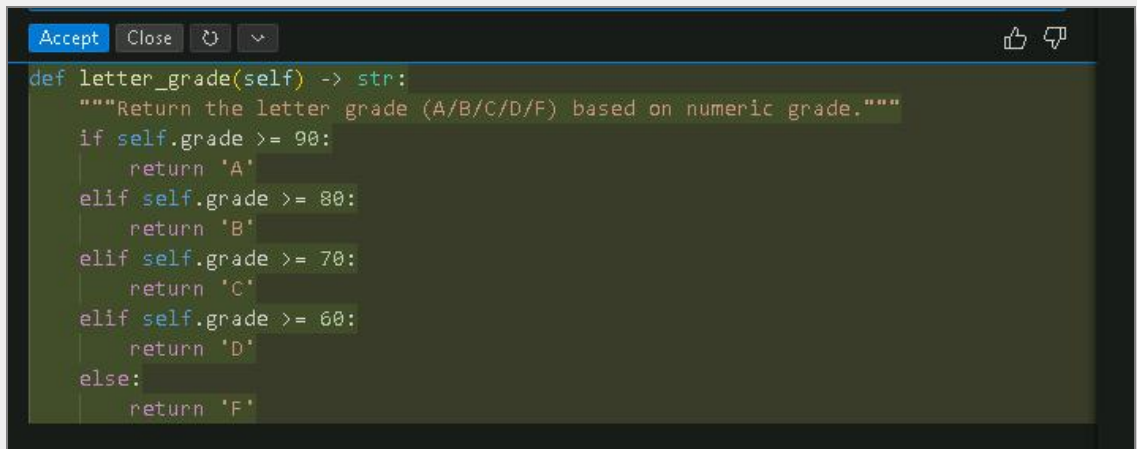
 *# Add a method letter_grade() returning A/B/C/D/F using 90/80/70/60 cutoffs.*

- In the Copilot Inline Chat (**Ctrl+I**) textbox, enter the following prompt: **T** Add a new letter_grade() method. Generate this new method. and select **Send**.



```
108     return students
109
110     # Add a method letter_grade() returning A/B/C/D/F using 90/80/70/60 cutoffs.
111
112
113 if __name__ == "__main__":
```

- Accept the generated code.



```
def letter_grade(self) -> str:
    """Return the letter grade (A/B/C/D/F) based on numeric grade."""
    if self.grade >= 90:
        return 'A'
    elif self.grade >= 80:
        return 'B'
    elif self.grade >= 70:
        return 'C'
    elif self.grade >= 60:
        return 'D'
    else:
        return 'F'
```

 Want to learn more? Review the documentation on [using Inline Chat in VS Code](#).

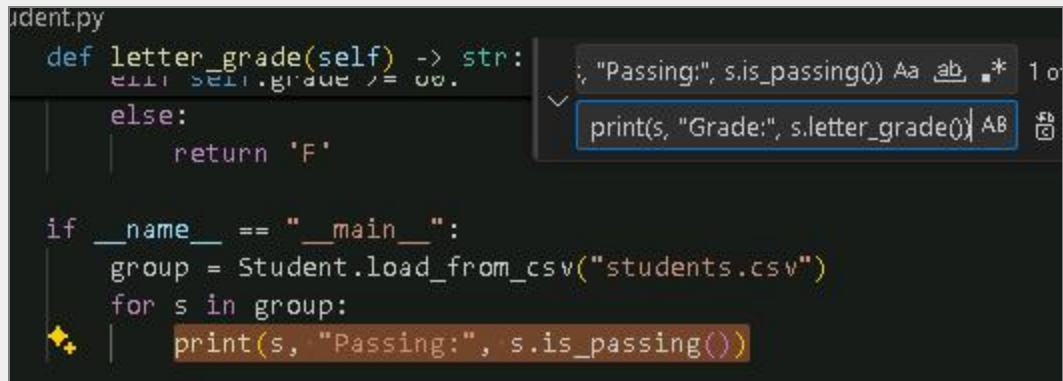
- Update the test block by using the code below, and then verify the output by using the **T** python student.py command.

python

 **print**(s, "Grade:", s.letter_grade())

💡 Expand this hint for guidance on updating the test block and verifying output. ^

- Use the code supplied above to update the test block.



```

student.py
def letter_grade(self) -> str:
    elif self.grade >= 80:
        return 'A'
    else:
        return 'F'

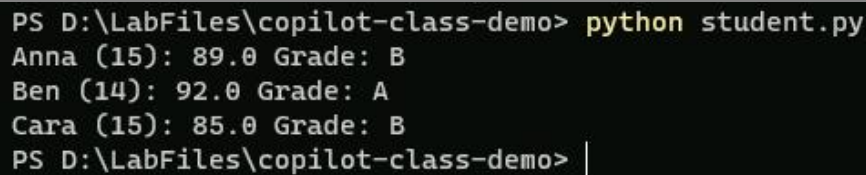
if __name__ == "__main__":
    group = Student.load_from_csv("students.csv")
    for s in group:
        print(s, "Passing:", s.is_passing())

```

- In the Terminal, run the following command:

bash

 python student.py



```

PS D:\LabFiles\copilot-class-demo> python student.py
Anna (15): 89.0 Grade: B
Ben (14): 92.0 Grade: A
Cara (15): 85.0 Grade: B
PS D:\LabFiles\copilot-class-demo>

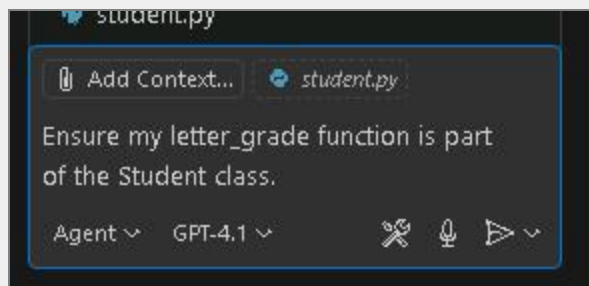
```

❓ If you receive an *AttributeError* error in the Terminal, expand this drop-down menu for help. ^

Full error message: *AttributeError: 'Student' object has no attribute 'letter_grade'.*

- If you have received the error message above, in the Copilot Chat textbox (**Ctrl+Shift+I**), enter the following prompt:

T Ensure my letter_grade method is part of the Student class.



- Ensure Copilot has moved the letter_grade method above the test code block.

- Select **Keep**, save the file, and then run the *python* command again:

```
bash
```

```
 python student.py
```



Want to learn more? Review the documentation on:

- [Prompt engineering in VS Code](#)
- [Prompt examples for chat in VS Code](#)

Check your work

Verify

Summary

Congratulations, you have completed the **Create a Class from a Prompt Using GitHub Copilot** Challenge Lab.

You have accomplished the following:

- Prepared the workspace.
- Generated and tested code with Copilot.
- Enhanced code and extended a class with Copilot.

Ending your lab

To ensure your lab is recorded as complete, select **Submit** or **End** below. Exiting [X] the lab will result in an incomplete status.

 Once you select **Submit** or **End**, you will not be able to return to this Challenge Lab.

Your feedback is important!

As you end your Challenge Lab, please take a few minutes to complete the short survey that will appear in the next window. Alternatively, you may provide your feedback directly to [Challenge Labs feedback](#).

Looking for your next Challenge Lab?

Below are recommended Challenge Labs to try next.

- Set Up Git and Connect to GitHub [Prerequisite Lab]
- Create a Class from a Prompt Using GitHub Copilot [Guided]
- Build Features by Using Copilot in Python [Guided]
- Write Unit Tests Automatically by Using Copilot [Guided]
- Add Comments and Docstrings by Using Copilot [Guided]
- Develop an API Client with GitHub Copilot [Guided]
- Refactor Python Code by Using Copilot [Guided]

- Create Shell Scripts by Using Copilot [Guided]
- Automate CI Workflows by Using GitHub Actions [Guided]
- Document Projects by Using Markdown and Copilot [Guided]
- Refactor and Optimize Code with GitHub Copilot [Guided]
- Build Command-Line Tools by Using Copilot [Guided]
- Utilize Copilot for Python Code Correction [Guided]

